

THEGAPBRIEF · SIDE REPORT · OCTOBER 28, 2026

Building an Obnoxious Genius: An Original AI Influencer for Higgsfield, 20 Viral Formats to Remake and a Full Character Bible

What kind of AI character is winning on TikTok, Instagram and X right now, 20 proven formats to remake, and a complete design for our own character: look, outfits, voice, name, launch plan and risks.

Assigned by Jacob Peterson · Research. Checked Oct 28, 2026. Every claim links to its source; numbers appear only where a cited source states them. The character, prompts, name ideas and launch plan are our own creative proposals, not sourced facts.

SUMMARY Bottom line

1 Build an uncanny "signature-look" character with one recurring bit, and label it as AI

The AI characters that took off this fall don't try to pass as human. They have one exaggerated, instantly readable silhouette and get dropped into whatever format is trending that day. Higgsfield says so itself: "A flawless face is the fastest way for a character to read as generic AI" (Semafor, Oct 7). Our proposal is **Professor Smugworth**: a lanky, wild-haired, insufferably confident "genius" in a lab coat over a loud suit who explains everything, is wrong half the time, and never admits it. He fits the format, he's original, and the name came up clean in a light search.

Semafor · Top5Apps

BEST TYPE Which kind of AI influencer works right now

2.1 The evidence: signature-look characters dropped into trends

- **Jean Philanthrope** (mustache, suit, shadowboxing): first post Sep 17; 240K Instagram and 267.7K TikTok followers by Oct 8, per UNILAD. UNILAD
- **@charles.robinson62** (barefoot guy stepping out of Lamborghinis): 948K Instagram followers by Oct 11; top video 99.6M views, per JARRUS. He's a Higgsfield Creative Partner. JARRUS
- **"Tall Lord Farquaad"**: 94.4K Instagram and 209.6K TikTok followers within a week, with "Made with @higgsfield.ai" in the bio. It borrows a DreamWorks character, which is the risky shortcut to avoid. Top5Apps
- **Candy the greyhound** (pinstripe suit, UFC-style press conferences): the creator reported 86M+ impressions and 55K+ followers, plus fighter collabs and client work. Starbelo
- An Instagram AI character account reached 92.6K followers and 63.3M views on 10 posts using a character sheet, self-filmed motion and a Higgsfield swap. TAU-HOME
- Higgsfield's own Oct 5 AI Influencer launch post on X: 5,065,598 views. Doomers

2.2 Why this type wins, and what to take from it

- **Readable in one frame.** Each winner has one silhouette you'd recognize as a thumbnail (mustache, bob, suit on a dog). Wild hair and a lab coat give us that.
- **The format does the work.** Farquaad "just dances … in whatever format is trending that day" (Top5Apps). The character is constant and the trend changes.
- **A personality beats a pretty face.** Candy works because combat sports is "a niche full of big personalities" (Starbelo). An obnoxious know-it-all gives us a voice and a recurring joke, not just a look.
- **Transparency is safer.** Openly AI accounts avoid Instagram's reach limits (see Risks).
- **Most new personas still flop.** Lightreel cites one at 956 followers and a 175-view median, so plan for volume and iteration. Lightreel

2.3 What Higgsfield supports, from its tool list (nothing was generated)

- **AI Influencer builder:** character sheets from human or animal trait options or presets, with a credit quote before anything is spent.
- **Soul Characters:** a reusable trained identity built from 5–20 reference images (about 10 minutes) so the face stays consistent.
- **Motion Control (Kling 3.0):** animate the character with the motion and camera of a reference video. This is the "put him in any trend" step.
- **Video generation,** including Seedance 2.5 scenes, plus upscaling and scene-by-scene video analysis (YouTube link or upload).
- **TikTok:** connect an account, browse TikTok's trending Commercial Music Library, and publish through a review form.

Source: the Higgsfield connector's tool descriptions, read Oct 28, 2026.

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20 FORMATS 20 proven viral formats to remake with our character

3.0 How to read this list

We copy the *format, hook and structure,* never anyone's footage, face, voice or likeness. View figures are what the source reports: ppl.studio's "top post" numbers for the month (as of Oct 28), Postdom's medians for top September posts, and creators' own reports. Postdom warns these are "top of TikTok's search results, not typical outcomes." Where no number is shown, the source gave none.

ppl.studio, Oct 2026 · Postdom trend study · NewEngen, Oct 2026

3.1 AI-character formats (Instagram, TikTok, X)

1. **Character dances through ordinary rooms to the day's trend** (Farquaad style; its TikTok had about 30M views across 37 videos by Oct 5). *Smugworth:* stiff, dignified dance in a lab, a laundromat and a DMV line, deadpan the whole time. source
2. **Caption-joke tile** ("REASONS TO GET A BOB," 429,000 views). *Smugworth:* "REASONS MY HAIR IS LIKE THIS" with a static photo and five absurd scientific reasons. source

3. **Mock press conference** (Candy the greyhound, 86M+ impressions reported by the creator). *Smugworth:* a podium "press conference" announcing he has solved something trivial, like folding a fitted sheet. source
4. **Signature move on repeat** (Jean Phil's shadowboxing). *Smugworth:* a signature "chalkboard slam" where he writes a fake equation and taps it twice. source
5. **Real input vs. AI output side-by-side** (Lightreel's strongest reusable format, Oct 3–10). *Smugworth:* Jacob's behind-the-scenes motion clip next to Smugworth's version, captioned "my intern vs. me." source

3.2 Skit and talking formats

6. **"Telling AI to do something"** (top post 22.6M views). *Smugworth:* argues with a chatbot, loses, and declares victory anyway. source
7. **"Same text to a person vs AI"** (top post 2.7M). *Smugworth:* sends the same question to his "assistant" and to himself; his answer is longer and wronger. source
8. **"Me correcting myself" skit** (top post 1.3M). *Smugworth:* corrects himself three times, each time more confidently wrong. source
9. **Deadpan list series** (top post 1.4M). *Smugworth:* "Things I am better at than you, part 7," read flatly to camera. source
10. **"Unpopular opinion"** (median 232,725 views, n=10). *Smugworth:* "Unpopular opinion: gravity is overrated," then a 20-second "lecture." source
11. **"Two Fishes" deadpan opinions** (a Love Island USA sound for arguing questionable opinions with a straight face). *Smugworth:* passionately defends a ridiculous scientific "fact." source
12. **"Answer in one word"**. *Smugworth:* is asked to answer in one word and can't stop at fewer than forty. source
13. **"Who said [X] 3 times"** (@chipotle's version: 9,978,740 views by Oct 1). *Smugworth:* "Who said 'actually' 3 times?" and he teleports in. source

3.3 Reveal, reaction and carousel formats

14. **"This is your sign"** (highest median of any format with 10+ posts: 1,382,588 views). *Smugworth:* "This is your sign to stop asking me questions." source
15. **Expectation vs reality** (79.2x median views per follower, n=8, directional). *Smugworth:* "How I think my experiment will go" vs. hair on fire. source
16. **Reaction videos** (median 653,221 views, n=24). *Smugworth:* reacts to "life hacks" with withering corrections (to formats, never to someone's actual clip without permission). source
17. **"Tell me your unhinged hacks" comment bait** (top post 3.9M). *Smugworth:* asks followers for hacks, then "peer reviews" the best comments in a follow-up. source
18. **"Did I win this trend" costume** (top post 40.5M). *Smugworth:* dresses as "the concept of entropy" and insists he won. source
19. **Fan transition outfit reveal** (overhead fan-blade transition). *Smugworth:* lab coat to tuxedo to hazmat suit, his hair getting wilder with each cut. source
20. **"Pray For Me" slow-mo entrance**. *Smugworth:* a cinematic slow-motion walk into a library, sparks flying, then he trips. source

Trending sounds should come from TikTok's Commercial Music Library (available through the Higgsfield TikTok tools) so the music is licensed for the account.

CHARACTER The character: Professor Smugworth

4.1 Visual references (archetypes, not people)

He draws on the long-running "absent-minded professor" and "mad scientist" archetypes: wild hair, chalk dust and a lab coat. Wikipedia notes Einstein's "expressive face and distinctive hairstyles have been widely copied" in that archetype. We use the *archetype* only. No Einstein face, no Doc Brown, no Rick Sanchez, no Bill Nye. Einstein's name and likeness are commercially licensed by an agent for the Hebrew University, so stay well clear.

Wikipedia · The Guardian

4.2 Face, age and build

- **Age:** reads as 38–45, "young enough to be annoying, old enough to be smug."
- **Build:** very tall and lanky, with a slightly too-long neck and long fingers he steeples constantly. That's a deliberate Higgsfield-style exaggeration so he reads as a character, not a real person.
- **Face:** long, narrow face with high cheekbones and a sharp pointed nose. Permanently raised left eyebrow, thin lips locked in a half-smirk, a small gap in the front teeth, faint chalk smudge on one cheek.
- **Eyes:** unusually pale ice-grey and a little too wide, behind small perfectly round wire glasses perched low on the nose so he looks over them.
- **Skin and detail:** slightly pale with ink stains on the fingertips. Clean-shaven except for long, sharply angled sideburns.

4.3 Hair: wild version and tamer version

- **Wild (signature):** a tall, electrified copper-orange mane that shoots upward and backward like he just touched a Van de Graaff generator, with one stubborn curl that falls over his forehead and a single white streak on the left. It should look dramatic in silhouette.
- **Tamer ("conference mode"):** the same copper hair slicked back hard with visible comb lines, the white streak showing and the forehead curl still escaping. Use it for "serious" episodes and sponsor reads.
- **Running gag:** the hair gets wilder as he gets more wrong or more angry, so it works as a visual meter.

4.4 Expressions and mannerisms

- **Expressions:** the over-the-glasses stare; the slow condescending blink; a smug closed-eye nod; a sudden manic grin when he has an "idea"; a frozen, eye-twitching smile when he's proven wrong.
- **Mannerisms:** steepled fingers; pushing his glasses up with one finger before correcting someone; tapping the chalkboard twice (signature move); a little bow after saying something wrong; sniffing a beaker before drinking coffee out of it.

4.5 Voice and catchphrase style

- **Voice:** a crisp, nasal tenor with over-pronounced consonants and dramatic pauses. Mid-Atlantic, "lecture hall" cadence. Speeds up when excited and drops to a whisper for "the important part." Build it with a synthetic voice; never clone a real person's voice.
- **Catchphrase style:** short and repeatable, starting with a correction.
  - "Ah. Ah-ah-ah. *Actually.*" (the opener)
  - "Peer reviewed. By me." (sign-off)
  - "I'm not wrong. I'm early."
  - "Write that down. No, the other hand."

4.6 Outfits and props

- **Signature outfit:** a knee-length white lab coat with singed cuffs and pockets stuffed with pens, worn over a mustard-and-burgundy windowpane three-piece suit, a teal bow tie, purple socks visible above scuffed oxblood brogues, and a pocket protector that reads "PhD (pending)."
- **Alternate 1, "Gala Genius":** a velvet emerald tuxedo jacket, black turtleneck and round gold glasses. For award-show parodies and press conferences.
- **Alternate 2, "Field Work":** an orange hazmat suit with the hood down so the wild hair explodes out, plus aviator goggles on his forehead.
- **Alternate 3, "Off Duty":** a cardigan with elbow patches over a T-shirt reading "I ♥ BEING RIGHT," plus corduroys. For casual formats and Lives.
- **Signature props:** a pointer that's slightly too long; a smoking beaker he drinks coffee from; a pocket chalkboard; a tiny brass bell he rings when someone is wrong; and a lab rat sidekick named "Dr. Cheese" (non-speaking, unimpressed).

4.7 Color palette

- Copper hair **#C4602D** · lab-coat white **#F4F1EA** · mustard **#D9A21B** · burgundy **#7A1F2B** · teal accent **#1F8A8A** · chalkboard green **#2F4F3A**.
- Use teal and copper on thumbnails and the profile picture so the account is recognizable at a glance.

4.8 Personality bible

- **Core:** a self-declared genius with total confidence and patchy accuracy. He's obnoxious the way a sitcom character is, smug and pompous, so the joke is always on him.
- **Backstory:** claims three PhDs ("two pending, one spiritual"), was "asked to leave" every university, and runs the "Smugworth Institute," which is his garage.
- **What he says:** corrections, fake equations, over-explanations of simple things, backhanded compliments ("Impressive, for a non-genius"), and grudging praise for Dr. Cheese.
- **What he never says:** "I was wrong" (only "the data was rude"). Nothing punching down at real groups or real people. No medical, financial or legal advice presented as real. No politics, slurs or anything sexual. No real brand put-downs, and he never pretends to be human or a real expert.
- **Weakness that makes him likable:** scared of pigeons, loses to Dr. Cheese at chess, and secretly reads every comment.

4.9 Ready-to-use Higgsfield prompt text

Character sheet / Soul reference prompt:

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Original fictional character "Professor Smugworth": very tall lanky man, appears 40, long narrow face, high cheekbones, sharp pointed nose, permanently raised left eyebrow, thin smug half-smirk, small front-tooth gap, pale ice-grey slightly too-wide eyes, small round wire glasses low on nose, long angled sideburns, clean-shaven, slightly elongated neck, ink-stained long fingers. Hair: tall electrified copper-orange mane shooting upward and back, one curl over forehead, single white streak on left side. Outfit: knee-length white lab coat with singed cuffs and pens in pockets over mustard-and-burgundy windowpane three-piece suit, teal bow tie, purple socks, oxblood brogues. Character sheet: front, 3/4, profile, back, full body and close-up expressions (smug, condescending blink, manic grin, frozen eye-twitch smile). Neutral grey studio background, photoreal but slightly uncanny stylized proportions. Not resembling any real person or existing character.
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Tame-hair variant: `Same character, copper hair slicked back flat with visible comb lines, white streak visible, single curl escaping onto forehead.`

Scene prompt template: `Professor Smugworth [ACTION] in [LOCATION], looking over his glasses at camera with a smug half-smirk, cinematic vertical 9:16, soft key light, chalk dust in the air, wild copper hair moving.`

Workflow: generate 4 sheet options in the AI Influencer builder (quote the credits first), pick one, and train a Soul Character on 5–20 consistent images. Then use Motion Control with Jacob's own self-filmed motion clips or licensed trend references for each format.

NAME 10 name candidates (light check, not legal clearance)

5.1 Candidates and what a quick web search showed (Oct 28)

1. **Professor Smugworth**: no matching creator, character or mark turned up in our search. *Top pick.*
2. **Thaddeus Voltmore**: no exact match found. "Thaddeus" alone is a common fictional first name (e.g. *Get Smart*).
3. **Ozwin Krank**: no exact match found.
4. **Dr. Fennick Blitz**: no exact match found.
5. **Dr. Barnaby Fuse**: no exact match found.
6. **Dr. Smartley**: no exact match found, but it's generic and weaker as a brand.
7. **Cornelius Brainard**: *avoid*. It matches a real Connecticut election candidate. CT elections
8. **Professor Know-It-All**: *weak*. It's a descriptive phrase that appears as a username, and a similar mark ("PROFESSOR KNOW") was filed in 1999 and is now dead. Markinton
9. **Dr. Kilowatt**: *avoid*. It's too close to Reddy Kilowatt, a trademark owned by Xcel Energy. Wikipedia

10. **Professor Einstein / anything "Einstein"**: *avoid*. "Professor Einstein" is already a TikTok creator name, and the Einstein name is licensed. Toklytics · The Guardian

Top pick: Professor Smugworth (nickname "Smuggy," handle idea @profsmugworth). It's made up and memorable, and it tells you the joke instantly. Before launch, check the handles on all three platforms and search USPTO (tmsearch.uspto.gov). Made-up names are generally stronger trademark candidates than descriptive ones. CharacterGuard guide

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LAUNCH Launch plan: first 10 posts and cadence

6.1 Cadence

Post one short video a day for the first 30 days on TikTok and Instagram Reels, and cross-post to X with a one-line caption. Add one carousel or tile a week. Postdom found posts under a week old averaged a median 104,176 views a day versus 22,404 at 28–30 days, so new posts do the heavy lifting and volume matters. Review after 10 posts: keep the 3 best-performing formats and drop the rest.

Postdom

6.2 First 10 posts

1. **Intro press conference:** "I am Professor Smugworth. You're welcome." (format 3)
2. **Trend dance through a lab, a DMV and a grocery store,** totally deadpan. (format 1)
3. **"This is your sign to stop asking me questions."** (format 14)
4. **Tile: "REASONS MY HAIR IS LIKE THIS."** (format 2)
5. **"Telling AI to do something":** loses an argument with a chatbot and claims victory. (format 6)
6. **Expectation vs reality:** the experiment and the hair on fire. (format 15)
7. **"Unpopular opinion: gravity is overrated."** (format 10)
8. **Fan-transition outfit reveal** through all 4 outfits. (format 19)
9. **"Tell me your unhinged hacks"** comment bait. (format 17)
10. **"Peer review" of the best comments from post 9,** with Dr. Cheese's debut. (formats 16/17)

Every post: AI label on, the same opener ("Ah-ah-ah. Actually.") and the same sign-off ("Peer reviewed. By me."). Jacob approves each post before it goes out.

RISKS Risks and rules

7.1 AI labeling

- **Instagram:** since Aug 31, 2026, profiles featuring an AI-generated person should switch on the "AI-generated profile" label. Unlabeled ones may lose recommendations. Instagram
- **TikTok:** requires labeling realistic AI content, through the toggle or on-screen text, and may auto-label C2PA-tagged uploads permanently. TikTok says the label alone doesn't reduce distribution. TikTok · TikTok Shop rules
- **X:** say "AI character" in the bio and on posts.

7.2 Impersonation, likeness and copyright

- TikTok bans using AI to imitate another person's likeness or voice, or to use someone else's name or trademarks without authorization. TikTok
- Borrowed characters are fragile. Farquaad's account "hands the series' future to a studio" that is suing AI model companies. Top5Apps
- Copying a *format* is normal; re-uploading someone's clip, cloning their face or lifting their jokes isn't. AI personas lifting comedians' sets drew public callouts this fall. Fanslist
- For Motion Control, use Jacob's own self-filmed motion or footage we have rights to, never someone else's viral clip as the reference.
- Use licensed music only (TikTok's Commercial Music Library) for anything branded or sponsored.

7.3 Copycats

Successful characters get cloned within days. Jean Phil copycats reached 147.6K and 21K followers. Lock the handles, keep dated records of first use, and consider a trademark once the name is in use. Fully AI images may have limited copyright protection, so the name and brand carry more of the protection. UNILAD · Evans Fox LLP

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